



Devi Academy students win the Playmaker Award. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Sportz Village-Get Kids to Play Summit **Chennai chapter puts spotlight on media's focus on inspiring children to take up sports**

The caravan of 'Sportz Village-Get Kids to Play Summit' made a pit stop at IIT-Madras for its third chapter on November 27.

The forum brought together various stakeholders from across the fraternity under one roof to discuss actionable ways to get the youth and children interested in taking up sports.

Ayon Sengupta, Editor of *Sportstar*, threw light on the media's role in lighting the proverbial spark. "At *The Hindu*, we focus on covering local age-group sports extensively. It is really heartening for a parent to find their kid's name in the newspaper," he said.

L. V. Navaneeth, CEO of *The Hindu Group*, added that the media must play a role in driving resources to the bottom of the pyramid. He said, "Our role is not only to highlight the problems but also be a part of the solution. What we do at *Sportstar* Conclaves is a step in the right direction... We need to talk more and get more

like-minded people on a shared platform."

IIT-Madras professor Dr. Mahesh Panchagnula delivered the keynote address. He said, "We have a plan to admit two students through Sports Excellence channels to each of the 16 B.Tech programmes here. At least one student in each of these departments will be a girl... Our vision is to have the first IITian-Olympian in a few years."

Naveen Velagapalli, managing trustee of Shraddha Children's Academy, elucidated the importance of balancing sports and academics. He said, "Although I want more Physical Education periods in my school, I have been unable to do it. There's pushback from teachers and parents. They say we don't have time to complete the syllabus."

The event additionally honoured companies which have come up with game-changing CSR programmes and talented schoolchildren with the Playmaker Awards.

SANTADEEP DEY